



Connecting Gemini CLI to Backstory MCP

September 25, 2026 · James McDaniel

Why connect

Gemini only knows what you paste into it or what it learned in training. It can't see what's actually happening in your deals. Once Backstory is connected, Gemini CLI can:

- Look up any account and pull its status, open opportunities, and scorecards
 - Summarize recent activity and show who's engaged on a deal
 - Answer SalesAI questions and flag risks on open opportunities
- Reps ask Gemini about a deal and get an answer built on real activity data, right from the terminal.

At a glance

Server URL	https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp
Authentication	OAuth 2.0, dynamic discovery
What you configure by hand	One command with the URL. No client IDs, secrets, or scopes.
Who signs in	Each user, with their own Backstory login. Data is scoped to what the user can see in Backstory.

How auth works Backstory MCP uses OAuth 2.0 with dynamic discovery. Gemini CLI reads the authorization endpoints from the server itself, so there are no client IDs, secrets, or scopes to configure by hand. You sign in once and Gemini CLI caches the token until you remove the server.

Before you start

- Gemini CLI installed and signed in with your Google account.
- Your Backstory sign-in: your email and your company identification. The connection authenticates as you, so Gemini sees only the data your Backstory user can see.
- The MCP server URL below — the only value you have to paste.

MCP server URL <https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp>

1. Add the Backstory server

Open your terminal and run:

```
gemini mcp add backstory https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp -t http --scope user
```

Part	What it does
------	--------------

backstory	The server name you'll use in later commands
-t http	Connects over streamable HTTP
--scope user	Makes Backstory available in every folder, not just the current project

Name it clearly A short name like **backstory** is easy to type in later commands and to spot in the /mcp list.

Watch the URL The path matters: the URL ends in /mcp. A missing path is the most common reason the connection fails and no tools appear.

2. Launch Gemini CLI

Start a session:
gemini

3. Sign in to Backstory

Inside Gemini CLI, run:

/mcp auth backstory

A Backstory sign-in window opens in your browser. Enter your email and your company identification and select **Sign In**, or use **Sign in with only an email address** to get a link instead. The second field is the company ID, not a password. When the browser confirms, return to the terminal.

Backstory sign-in

No browser? On a remote machine or SSH session, the sign-in window can't open locally. Run the setup on a machine with a browser, or copy the sign-in link from the terminal into a local browser.

4. Confirm the tools loaded

Run:

/mcp

backstory should show as connected, with the full list of Backstory tools under it.

/mcp → backstory → tool list

5. Approve tool calls

The first time Gemini calls a Backstory tool, it asks for confirmation. You can allow it once, always allow that tool, or always allow every tool from the server.

All read-only Every Backstory tool reads data and none can change your CRM, so always allowing the server is safe. Approval prompts are useful if you want to see each call as it happens.

Verify

- Ask something only Backstory can answer, such as **"What's the current status of [one of your accounts]?"**
- Confirm Gemini shows a Backstory tool call before it answers, rather than responding from general knowledge.
- Try other question types: **"Show recent activity for that account"**, **"Show me open opportunities for that account"**, or **"What are the risks on this opportunity?"**

Troubleshooting

Authentication fails. Confirm Gemini CLI itself is signed in with Google, then retry `/mcp auth backstory`. If it still fails, remove the server with **`gemini mcp remove backstory`** and run the add command from step 1 again.

Sign-in window never opens. A popup blocker or an earlier Backstory session in the same browser is interfering. Allow popups, or retry in a private window.

`/mcp` shows the server but no tools. Check the URL ends in `/mcp`, then restart Gemini CLI so it refetches the tool list.

Gemini answers without calling Backstory. The prompt is too generic. Name Backstory or a specific account in the question.

Gemini can't find the account. The name is misspelled, or your Backstory user can't see it. Try an account you know exists.

Wrong or empty data. Results are scoped to the Backstory user who authenticated. Confirm you signed in with the right company identification.

Need to disconnect. Run **`gemini mcp remove backstory`**. Follow steps 1–4 again to reconnect.